

TOURNAMENT DRAWINGS

Division I field is wide-open

Admiral King is 4th seed; Elyria, Southview meet in 1st round

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

GRAFTON — There were no surprises when it came to the seedings at the Division I District draw at Midview Saturday morning.

However, the rest of the field scrambled to line itself up for the best chance at advancing to the regional.

Strongsville (15-3), Lakewood St. Edward (10-6), Brunswick (12-5), and Lorain Admiral King (9-7) were seeded in that order and received first round byes, but that's when the fun began.

The defending champion is Medina, which is 5-11. There are six teams in the field with winning marks and three others that are near .500. It appears to be a competitive field.

Southview rookie coach Al McConchie, with the first pill stayed away from schedule tested St. Edward by going into second seed Strongsville's bracket and Elyria's John Smith, with the second pill, hesitated but eventually

FIRST ROUND Tuesday Feb 27 Medina vs. Westlake 6 p.m. Southview vs. Elyria 7:45 p.m. Wednesday Feb 28 Lakewood vs. Cloverleaf 6 p.m. Admiral King vs. Lakewood 7:45 p.m.
SECOND ROUND Friday March 2 Brunswick vs. Southview 6 p.m. Strongsville vs. Westlake 7:45 p.m. Saturday March 3 St. Edward vs. Medina 6 p.m. Admiral King vs. Lakewood 7:45 p.m.
DISTRICT SEMIFINALS Thursday March 8 (split session) Admiral King vs. Lakewood 6 p.m. St. Edward vs. Medina 6 p.m. Strongsville vs. Westlake 7:45 p.m.
DISTRICT FINAL Saturday March 10 Semifinal winners 7 p.m. Winner advances to regional semifinals at Cleveland State Seeds: 1. Strongsville, 2. St. Edward, 3. Brunswick, 4. Admiral King.

excited that we get a second chance at the Pioneers," said Southview coach Al McConchie.

"I think St. Eds is a notch above everybody else," said Smith. "I just felt going into the upper bracket, we're in pretty good shape."

"That's the first time I've ever got a pill that high. Usually your choices are made for you (Saturday) we had to kind of think through it. The tough part is you're not sure where the pills below you are going to fall. You always want to give yourself a chance to win at least one game in the tournament. That's why we took awhile to debate."

"It went pretty much as planned," said King coach John Rositano. "Even though Strongsville got the No. 1 seed — (St. Edward) has played top notch competition and they've played well lately. You always go with strength of schedule."

I thought even though they didn't get the No. 1 seed the respect by who went where was definitely shown.

chose to play the Saints

Elyria (8-9) defeated Southview (6-11) last week but took two overtimes to do it. The two will meet again in the second game on Tuesday, Feb. 27, with the winner facing Brunswick the following Friday.

Our kids will be ready and

Falls, Open Door get top seeds

Four area teams swept the seeds in the Division II sectional district tournament draw Saturday at Admiral King.

Southwestern Conference heavyweights Olmsted Falls (No. 1 seed) and Avon Lake (2) led the way, followed by Elyria Catholic (3) and North Ridgeville (4).

The Shoremen are the defending champions in the district, which begins Tuesday Feb. 27 and culminates with the title game Saturday March 10. The winner goes to the regional at Bowling Green's Anderson Arena.

Of the seeded teams, only Olmsted Falls and Elyria Catholic took byes. The Bulldogs will play either Midview or Fairview on Friday, March 2 at 7:45 while the Panthers get either Rocky River or Brookside on Saturday March 3 at 6 p.m.

FIRST ROUND Tuesday Feb 27 Fairview vs. Midview 6 p.m. North Ridgeville vs. Padua 7:45 p.m. Wednesday Feb 28 Avon Lake vs. Bay 6 p.m. Rocky River vs. Brookside 7:15 p.m.
SECOND ROUND

FIRST ROUND Monday Feb 26 Independence vs. Lake Ridge 6:30 p.m. Cuyahoga Heights vs. Dalton 8 p.m. Tuesday Feb 27 North Coast Christian vs. Elyria 6:30 p.m. Orange Christian vs. Lorain Catholic 8 p.m.
SECOND ROUND Friday March 2 Cuyahoga Heights vs. Dalton 6:30 p.m. Independence vs. Lake Ridge 8 p.m. Saturday March 3 Orange Christian vs. Lorain Catholic 6:30 p.m. North Coast Christian vs. Elyria 8 p.m.
DISTRICT SEMIFINALS Tuesday March 6 Cuyahoga Heights vs. Dalton 6:30 p.m. Independence vs. Lake Ridge 8 p.m. DISTRICT FINAL Friday March 9 Winner to regional at Canton

Division IV

Open Doors 16-1 season was awarded for the No. 1 seed in the Division IV sectional district draw Saturday at Strongsville.

Lutheran West, Independence and Lorain Catholic followed with the 2-4 seeds, respectively in action that begins Monday Feb. 26 at Strongsville High School.

Open Door earned a first round bye and will play either Cuyahoga Heights or Dalton Friday March 2 at 6:30 p.m.

The winner of the Strongsville district advances to the regional

FIRST ROUND Monday Feb 26 Independence vs. Lake Ridge 6:30 p.m. Cuyahoga Heights vs. Dalton 8 p.m. Tuesday Feb 27 North Coast Christian vs. Elyria 6:30 p.m. Orange Christian vs. Lorain Catholic 8 p.m.
SECOND ROUND Friday March 2 Cuyahoga Heights vs. Dalton 6:30 p.m. Independence vs. Lake Ridge 8 p.m. Saturday March 3 Orange Christian vs. Lorain Catholic 6:30 p.m. North Coast Christian vs. Elyria 8 p.m.
DISTRICT SEMIFINALS Tuesday March 6 Cuyahoga Heights vs. Dalton 6:30 p.m. Independence vs. Lake Ridge 8 p.m. DISTRICT FINAL Friday March 9 Winner to regional at Canton

Columbia is no match for Lutheran West

Longhorn defense is the difference down the stretch

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

ROCKY RIVER — How do you put a spin on the happenings at Lutheran West Saturday night?

The Longhorns were out rebounded 42-29. They sent Columbia to the free throw line 26 times in the first half alone.

Yet they managed to win the MAC 8 conference game going away, 76-55. Lutheran West, 5-8 in league play is now 5-13 overall while the Raiders fell to 4-13 overall and 3-10 in the MAC 8.

How did it happen?

For starters, Columbia turned the ball over 34 times.

Secondly, the Longhorns stopped fouling and started playing solid defense the second half.

Finally they had unexpected lifts off the bench from Matt Kasinecz, Josh Mancini and Josh Ronschke who combined to score 34 points for the Lutheran West.

Oh, and did we mention their 17-2 run midway through the third quarter?

Any more questions?

We played an awful third quarter, said Columbia's Chris Woost. "We couldn't handle the ball. Ball handling's the key. Not hitting the shots — getting frustrated — throwing the ball away — it's a young team."

Columbia's 6-foot-4 junior Joe Waldecker had quite a night for the Raiders. He pulled in 17 rebounds and scored 25 points, popping in eight of 11 first half free throws as the Raiders made 18 of 26 from the stripe the first half. Lutheran West committed 18 personal fouls and had one technical before intermission.

But once the Longhorns stopped sending Columbia to the line, things changed quickly. Columbia took only five more throws from the 15-foot stripe

the second half and made just one. Waldecker was 0 for 3.

"We gave them a lot of fouls early on," admitted Lutheran West coach Joe King. "We talked about it at halftime. If we just come out and play some good defense and not foul — that would be great."

Matt Kasinecz had a great game. He's probably our eighth or ninth man — comes every night — practices hard — doesn't complain. Tonight he gave us a spark and the other kids kind of rallied around what he did."

Kasinecz was the key figure in LW's deadly third quarter spurt. His bank shot with 2:14 to play gave the Longhorns a 39-36 lead and started a 10-0 run. He dropped in a turnaround jumper and a made a layup off a turnover as well.

In the fourth quarter, he made a 3 pointer two more banks, and a close range bunny to complete his 15 point night. His bench buddies, Mancini and Ronschke, added 11 and eight points respectively. Starters Ryan Helmink (15 points) and Jay Schnittger (13) did plenty of damage as well.

"All of our kids that played tonight, I thought, played pretty well," said King. "At times they did things they needed to do and at times they all got a lot of fouls they didn't need to give but we needed a win. We've been down and come up short a few games."

Columbia will try to rebound this weekend at home against Richmond Heights in league play Friday and at Avon Saturday in a non-league affair. The Longhorns are at Cuyahoga Heights Friday.

COLUMBIA (55) Gentry 11-13, Caldero 2-16, Sullivan 1-8, Vaynsky 4-19, Waldecker 8-25, Thompson 0-0, Mancini 5-11, 44 Total, 17-55
LUTHERAN WEST (76) Schnitzler 5-13, Helmink 4-11, Weber 0-0, Ziegler 1-0, Senney 3-2, Kasinecz 7-15, Schnittger 3-10, Ronschke 3-8, Mancini 0-0, Miller 0-0, Seney 1-0, 26 Total, 26-76
Columbia 13 19 17 — 50
Lutheran West 11 17 19 — 58
Three-point goals: Columbia 10-20, Lutheran West 3-10
Rebounds: Columbia 42, Waldecker 17, Lutheran West 23 (Helmink 5)
Turnovers: Columbia 34, Lutheran West 15
Fouls: Columbia 15, Lutheran West 25
Junior varsity: Lutheran West 59-18, Columbia 43-30

Gansey ties career high with 42

OLMSTED FALLS — Mike Gansey tied his career high by scoring 42 points as Olmsted Falls crushed Fast Liverpool in a non-conference game.

Gansey had earlier scored 42 points in a Jan. 12 game against Bay.

The Bulldogs overcame a four point halftime deficit by outscoring East Liverpool 30-14 in the third quarter. Garry Reutler also scored in double figures for Falls (13-4) with 12.

East Liverpool (14-3) was led by Joel McCready with 21 points.

ROUNDUP
Josh Reed with 17 and Roosevelt Kirby with 12
EAST LIVERPOOL (59) Sepp 2-0, Reed 6-17, Matthews 1-0, McCready 9-21, Kirby 5-0, 12
OLMSTED FALLS (72) M. Gansey 14-34, Stanton 2-5, Reutler 4-12, Forest 1-0, Sullivan 2-2, 5
East Liverpool 12 19 14 — 59
Olmsted Falls 15 12 30 — 57
Three-point goals: East Liverpool 2 (Hagg), Olmsted Falls 7 (M. Gansey, Stanton, Reutler, Sepp)
Junior varsity: Olmsted Falls 70, East Liverpool 45
Admiral King 58, Oregon Clay 50
LORAIN — Haze Massey's 16 points powered Admiral King to a Great Lakes League victory

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